

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1987-06-19

1 dear b ahá'í f riends,

2 1987 and has instructed us to send you the following reply.

The house of justice was very pleased to know how fruitful you have

3 found the consultation at your recent National conventions to have been.

4 The convention is, of course, free to decide that every suggestion made

5 by a delegate be recorded and conveyed to the National Spiritual Assembly. beyond
this, the National Assembly members who are present are always

6 free to note down for their own interest and further discussion any points that are
made. it is by no means necessary to have a formal consultation and

7 vote on every recommendation. it is important to remember, however, that

8 the National convention is not a conference, it is a consultative institution

9 of the faith; therefore, consultation and formal voting on recommendations

10 should not be ruled out altogether. There may, for example, be disagree-ment among
the delegates on certain proposals put forward, and it would be fruitful for the matter to be
discussed and voted upon so that the National Spiritual Assembly will know the
recommendation of the convention as a

11 whole on those issues.

detailed aspects of convention procedure which are not defined in the

12 National bahá'í constitution, being secondary in nature, are within the

13 discretion of each National Spiritual Assembly to decide. The house of

14 justice feels that it is generally advisable not to be rigid and to leave it to the

15 discretion of the convention officers, or the convention itself, to decide

which recommendations need to be discussed and voted upon and which

16 may be recorded without more ado. A distinction should be made in the 29.9

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31 1986–1992 • The Six Year Plan

32 59record between recommendations of the entire convention and those which
33 are merely the proposals of individual delegates.

34 with loving Bahá'í greetings,

Department of the Secretariat

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The Bahá'í Role in Promoting World Peace

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]